



## RED BANNER ALERT



# SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

|                              |               |                                  |            |
|------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------|------------|
| <b>Date of Incident:</b>     | 22/02/2023    | <b>Time of Incident:</b>         | 13:15      |
| <b>Directorate / Region:</b> | GSR           | <b>Main Roads or Contractor:</b> | Contractor |
| <b>EQSafe Event Type:</b>    | Near Miss     | <b>EQSafe Incident Number:</b>   | 30063      |
| <b>Actual Consequence:</b>   | Insignificant | <b>Potential Consequence:</b>    | Major      |

|                                    |                                                                 |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Incident Short Description:</b> | Workers within 1.2m of traffic in unauthorised second work area |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|

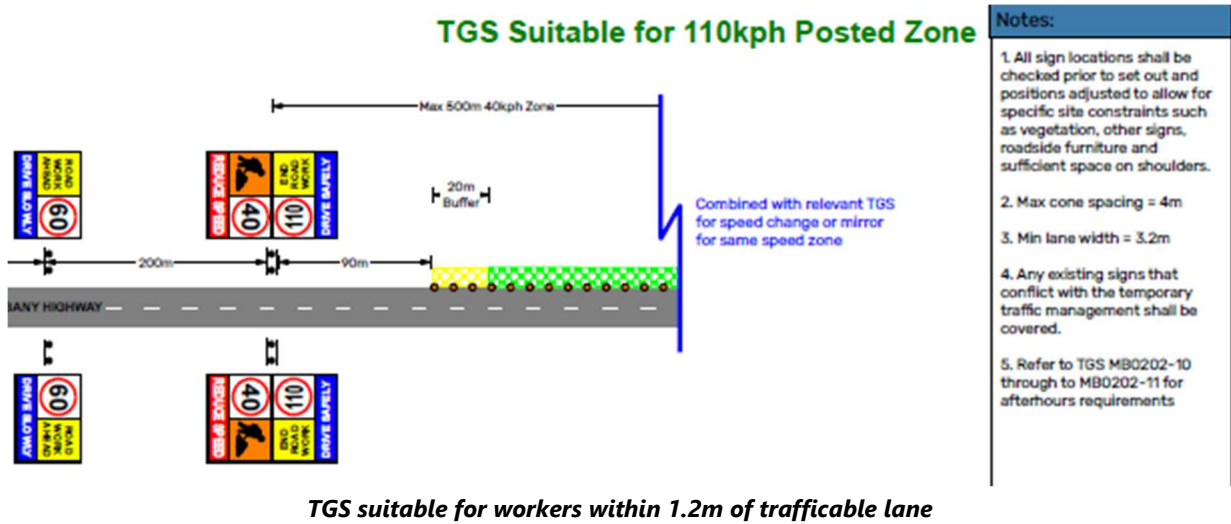
### What Happened:

Work on shoulder widening was being undertaken in a 2km work area with posted speed of 110kph, speed was reduced to 60kph and a FOLLOW ME vehicle was in operation. A separate work crew were undertaking compaction testing on the shoulder of the live lane, opposite of the main work area.



An errant member of the public vehicle was travelling behind the FOLLOW ME vehicle close to the pavement edge. No workers were spotting as vehicles approached or moving back from pavement.

TGS contained statement that workers on foot to be greater than 1.2m from the trafficable lane. This is accordance with the code of practice with speed reduced to 60kph. For workers to be within 1.2m, speed must be 40kph and delineation (cones) at 4m spacings between workers and trafficable lane.



The workers undertaking task resulted in two work areas within the TC controlled area, this was not in accordance with the TGS.

A formal ICAM investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.



This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk profile relating to Interaction with live traffic

**Immediate Actions:**

Please note that these are generic actions for all to consider in relation to this critical risk (and is not reflective of this specific incident):

- Reinforce Traffic controllers have the right to hold traffic if hazard exists
- Discuss at toolbox meetings requirement to follow the Traffic Guidance Schemes, and if work layout changes deviations must be approved
- Communicate event and review SWMS interaction with traffic controls with all workers to assist address Workers becoming complacent, hazard perception changes